Minutes of the Inaugural Meeting of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax Held in the Council Chambers of the Town Hall on Monday, November 28, 2022 at 7:00 p.m.

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
accessibility@ajax.ca *or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347*

Present:	Mayor	S. Collier
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		S. Lee
		J. Dies
	Councillors	R. Tyler Morin
		N. Henry
		L. Bower

1. Piping in of Council

Mr. Glen Healy, Piper, led Council-elect to their respective positions on the dais.

2. Acknowledgement of Traditional Treaty Lands and Opening Remarks

Nicole Cooper, Director of Legislative & Information Services/Town Clerk, opened the inaugural meeting, acknowledged traditional treaty lands, and welcomed members of the audience to the inaugural meeting of Council for the 2022-2026 Term of Office. N. Cooper discussed local democracy and highlighted positive indicators of a healthy democracy in Ajax. On behalf of the senior management team and Town staff, N. Cooper congratulated each of the successful members of Council on their election.

3. Declarations of Office

The Deputy Clerk issued the Declaration of Office to each of the Council members-elect, who recited and signed the declaration.

N. Cooper officially presented Members of the 2022-2026 term of Council.

4. Presentation of Chain of Office to Mayor

The Clerk presented the Chain of Office to Mayor Shaun Collier. Mayor Collier assumed the chair for the remainder of the meeting.

5. National Anthem

The Mayor introduced Alex Whorms who performed the National Anthem.

6. Indigenous Blessing and Smudging Ceremony

Elder Kim Wheatley, introduced herself, offered greetings, and congratulated all members of Council, new and returning. Elder Wheatley discussed the importance of accountability, responsibility, and kindness. Elder Wheatley performed a traditional smudging ceremony, offered a prayer and a song, and addressed those gathered for the meeting.

7. Inaugural Address

Mayor Collier opened his inaugural address by thanking his family, friends, and volunteers for their support throughout the election campaign, and highlighted accomplishments from the previous term of Council. Mayor Collier highlighted some of the priorities of the new Council, including the creation and implementation of an indigenous consultation process

for future development plans, the official opening of the indigenous community healing garden at Ajax Pickering Hospital, housing affordability and homelessness strategies, funding for charities and community organizations through the Ajax Partnership Fund, and enhancing public safety. Mayor Collier invited all residents to engage with the Members of Council during the term.

Mayor Collier invited each member of Council to make further comments. Members of Council offered their sincere thanks to their family, friends, and supporters, and commented on important issues in the upcoming term of Council.

8. Confirming By-Law

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That By-law number 68-2022 being a by-law to confirm the proceedings of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax at its inaugural meeting held on November 28, 2022 be read a first, second and third time and passed.

CARRIED

On behalf of Council, Mayor Collier thanked Dave Lang, Fire Chief for his service to the Town of Ajax and wished him luck in his retirement. Further, Mayor Collier extended best wishes to Aaron Burridge in his new role as Acting Fire Chief.

Mayor Collier thanked all in attendance and congratulated Regional Chair John Henry on his re-election.

9. Adjournment

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: J. Dies

That the November 28, 2022 inaugural meeting of the Council of the Town of Ajax be adjourned. (8:03 p.m.)

CARRIED

10. Piping out of Council

Mr. Glen Healy, Piper, concluded the meeting by leading Council out of the chambers.

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Mayor

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D-Clerk